

Pickle Rick

Web enumeration, command execution, and ingredient discovery

Spoiler warning: This writeup explains the complete solution path for the TryHackMe Pickle Rick room. The final room answers are redacted in this public version.

Platform: TryHackMe | **Difficulty:** Easy | **Room:** picklerick | **Room URL:** <https://tryhackme.com/room/picklerick>

Scope and environment

This write-up documents the solution path for the authorized TryHackMe Pickle Rick lab. The target address is represented as <MACHINE_IP> because the room assigns a temporary IP address each time the machine is deployed.

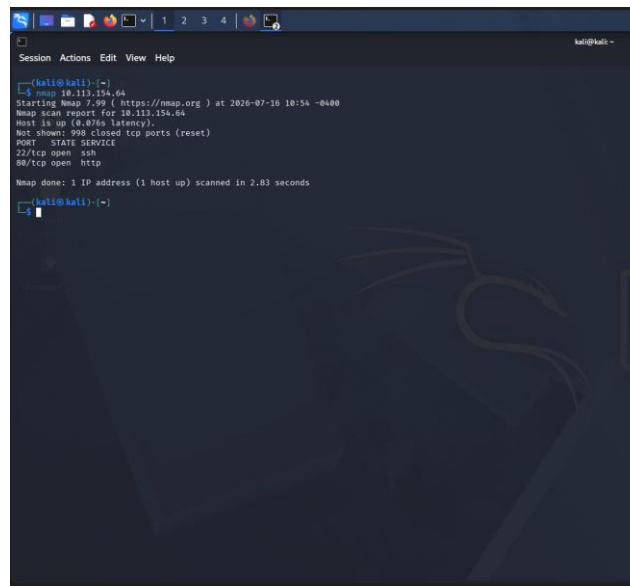
Reconnaissance

I began with a basic Nmap scan to identify reachable TCP services on the target.

```
nmap <MACHINE_IP>
```

The scan identified two open ports: 22/tcp for SSH and 80/tcp for HTTP. Because the challenge presents a web application, I prioritized the HTTP service for further investigation.

Evidence - Basic Nmap scan showing ports 22 and 80.

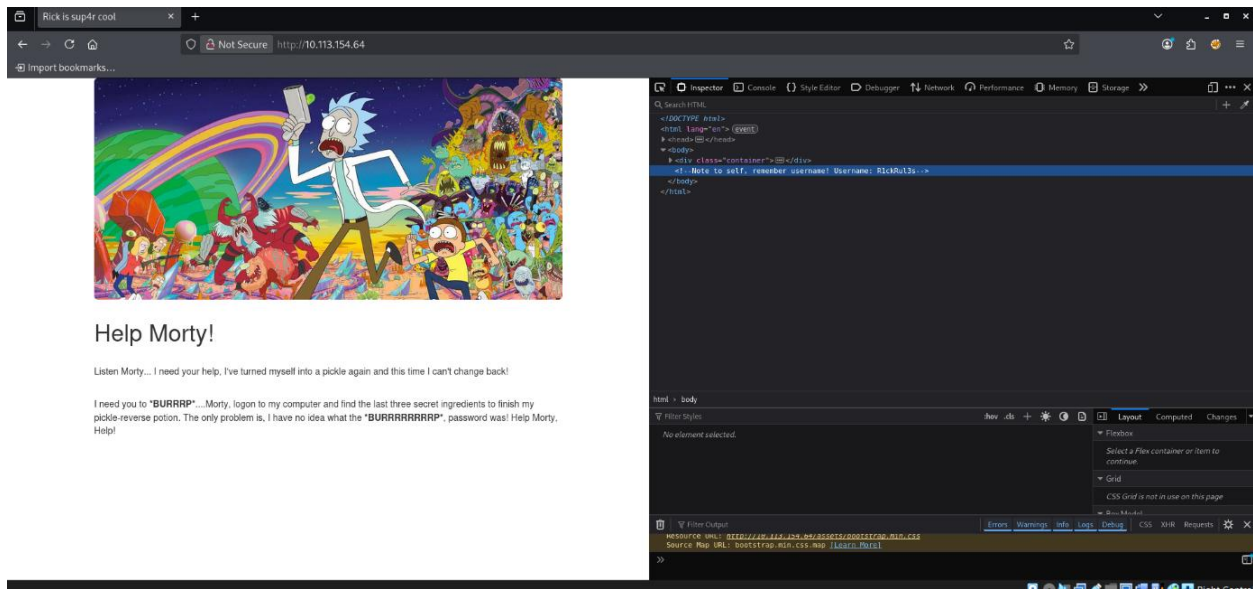
A screenshot of a terminal window with a dark background. The terminal shows the output of an Nmap scan. The first line is a prompt '(kali@kali): ~'. The second line is the command 'nmap 10.111.154.64'. The output follows: 'Starting Nmap 7.99 (https://nmap.org) at 2026-07-10 10:54 -0400', 'Nmap scan report for 10.111.154.64', 'Host is up (0.076s latency).', 'Not shown: 998 closed tcp ports (reset)', 'PORT STATE SERVICE', '22/tcp open ssh', '80/tcp open http', and 'Nmap done: 1 IP address (1 host up) scanned in 2.83 seconds'. The prompt '(kali@kali): ~' appears again at the bottom.

Web enumeration

HTML source inspection

I opened the web application and inspected the HTML source. A developer comment exposed a username that could be used for authentication.

Evidence - Username disclosed in an HTML comment.



Username: R1ckRu13s

Directory enumeration

I used Gobuster with PHP, HTML, and TXT extensions to identify resources that were not linked directly from the home page.

```
gobuster dir -u http://<MACHINE_IP> -w /usr/share/wordlists/dirb/common.txt -x php,html,txt
```

Evidence - Gobuster directory enumeration results.

```
(kali@kali)-[~]
$ gobuster dir -u http://10.113.154.64 -w /usr/share/wordlists/dirb/common.txt -x php,html,txt

Gobuster v3.8.2
by OJ Reeves (@TheColonial) & Christian Mehlmauer (@firefart)

[+] Url: http://10.113.154.64
[+] Method: GET
[+] Threads: 10
[+] Wordlist: /usr/share/wordlists/dirb/common.txt
[+] Negative Status codes: 404
[+] User Agent: gobuster/3.8.2
[+] Extensions: php,html,txt
[+] Timeout: 10s

Starting gobuster in directory enumeration mode

.hta (Status: 403) [Size: 278]
.hta.php (Status: 403) [Size: 278]
.hta.html (Status: 403) [Size: 278]
.hta.txt (Status: 403) [Size: 278]
.htaccess (Status: 403) [Size: 278]
.htaccess.php (Status: 403) [Size: 278]
.htaccess.html (Status: 403) [Size: 278]
.htaccess.txt (Status: 403) [Size: 278]
.htpasswd (Status: 403) [Size: 278]
.htpasswd.php (Status: 403) [Size: 278]
.htpasswd.html (Status: 403) [Size: 278]
.htpasswd.txt (Status: 403) [Size: 278]
assets (Status: 301) [Size: 315] [→ http://10.113.154.64/assets/]
denied.php (Status: 302) [Size: 0] [→ /login.php]
index.html (Status: 200) [Size: 1062]
index.html (Status: 200) [Size: 1062]
login.php (Status: 200) [Size: 882]
Progress: 11610 / 18452 (62.92%) [ERROR] error on word notified.php: timeout occurred during the request
portal.php (Status: 302) [Size: 0] [→ /login.php]
robots.txt (Status: 200) [Size: 17]
robots.txt (Status: 200) [Size: 17]
server-status (Status: 403) [Size: 278]
Progress: 18452 / 18452 (100.00%)

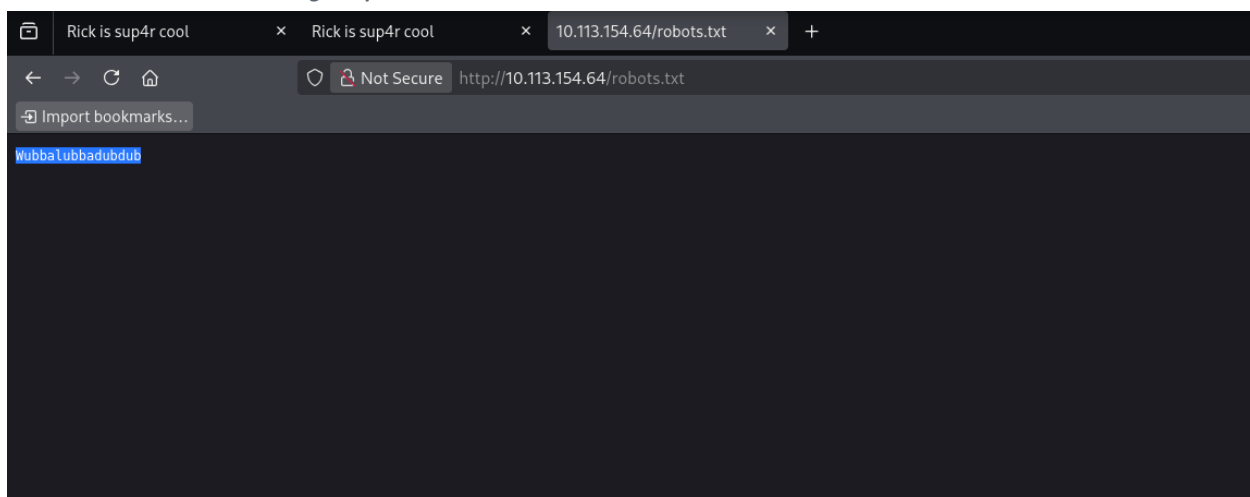
Finished
```

The results included login.php, robots.txt, and portal.php. The 302 redirect from portal.php to login.php indicated that the command portal required authentication.

Credential discovery in robots.txt

I inspected robots.txt before attempting to log in. Instead of normal crawler directives, the file contained a standalone string. I treated this value as a password candidate for the username discovered in the page source.

Evidence - robots.txt containing the password candidate.



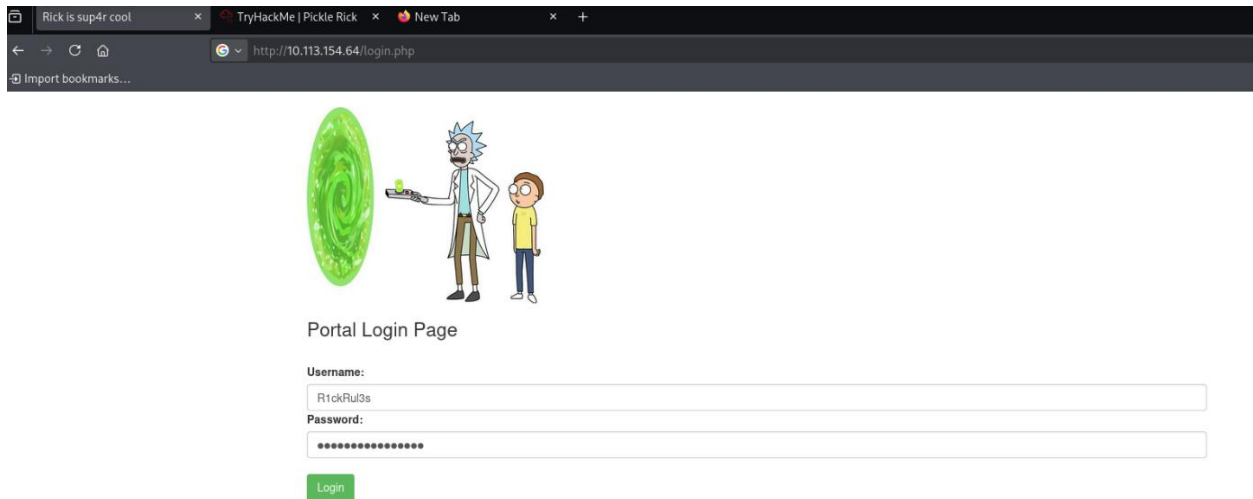
Password candidate: WubbaLubbaDubdub

Authentication

I submitted the discovered username and password on login.php. Authentication succeeded and the application redirected me to the command panel at portal.php.

Credentials: R1ckRu13s / WubbaLubbaDubdub

Evidence - Credentials entered on the portal login page.

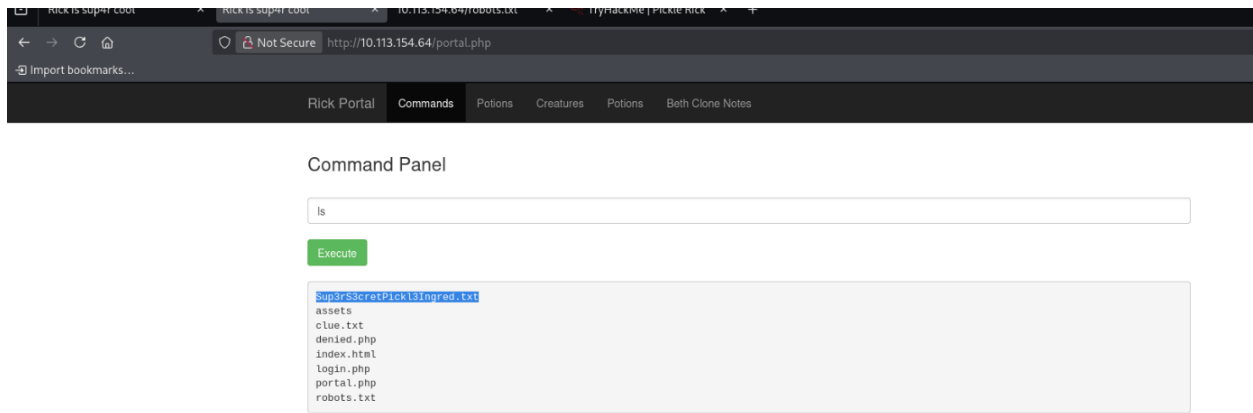


Command execution and the first ingredient

The authenticated portal accepted operating-system commands. I first listed the contents of the current web directory.

```
ls
```

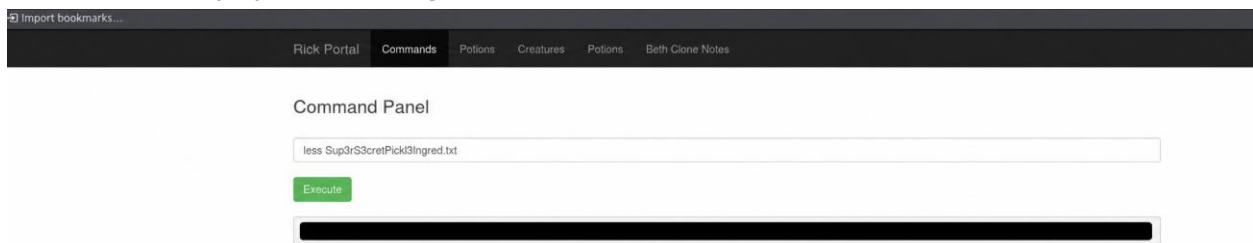
Evidence - Listing the files in the web directory.



The listing revealed Sup3rS3cretPickl3Ingred.txt. I used less to display the contents of the file.

```
less Sup3rS3cretPickl3Ingred.txt
```

Evidence - Contents of Sup3rS3cretPickl3Ingred.txt.



```
First ingredient: [REDACTED]
```

Locating the second ingredient

After finding the first ingredient in the web directory, I enumerated the root filesystem and then followed the user directories under /home.

```
ls /
```

Evidence - Root filesystem listing.

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[Rick Portal](#) [Commands](#) [Potions](#) [Creatures](#) [Potions](#) [Beth Clone Notes](#)

Command Panel

Execute

bin
boot
dev
etc
home
initrd.img
initrd.img.old
lib
lib64
lost+found
media
mnt
opt
proc
root
run
sbin
snap
srv
sys
tmp
usr
var
vmlinuz
vmlinuz.old

```
ls /home
```

Evidence - User directories under /home.

[Rick Portal](#) [Commands](#) [Potions](#) [Creatures](#) [Potions](#) [Beth Clone Notes](#)

Command Panel

Execute

rick
ubuntu

```
ls /home/rick
```

Evidence - The second ingredients file in /home/rick.

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[Rick Portal](#) [Commands](#) [Potions](#) [Creatures](#) [Potions](#) [Beth Clone Notes](#)

Command Panel

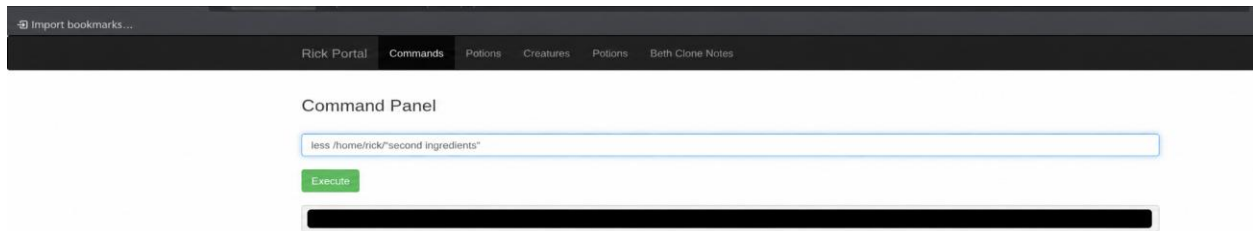
Execute

"second ingredients"

The filename contains a space, so I enclosed it in straight double quotes to ensure the shell treated the complete name as one argument.

```
less /home/rick/"second ingredients"
```

Evidence - Contents of the second ingredients file.



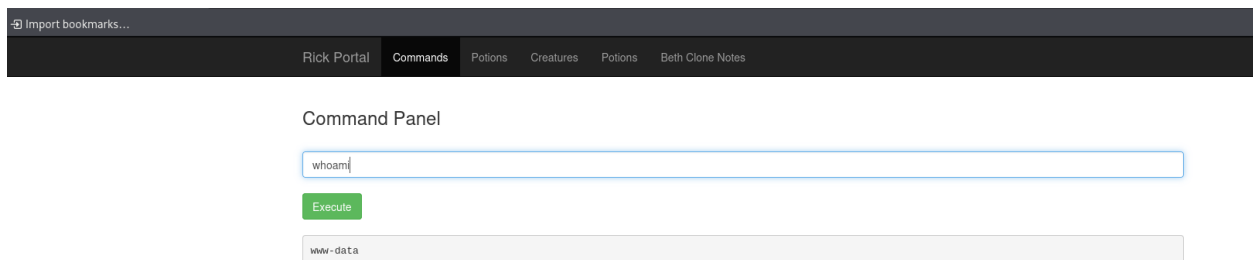
Second ingredient: [REDACTED]

Privilege context and the final ingredient

Before accessing /root, I checked which operating-system account was executing commands through the web portal.

```
whoami
```

Evidence - whoami confirms that portal commands run as www-data.

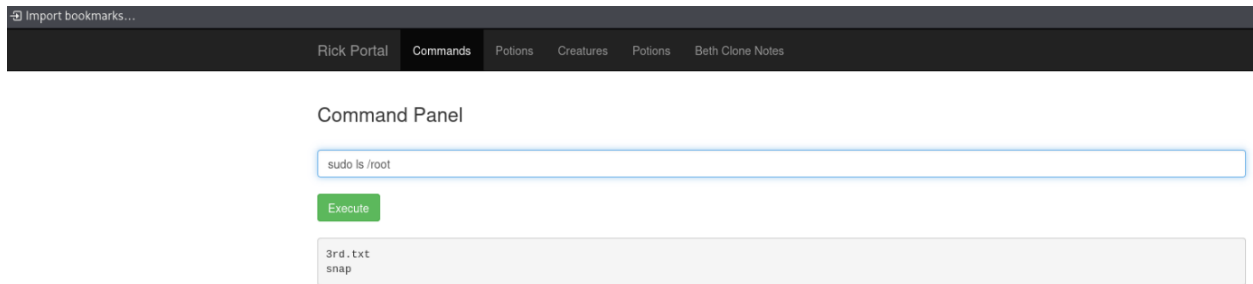


The output was www-data, confirming that commands were running as the restricted web-service account.

To determine whether the web-service account could execute commands with elevated privileges, I tested access to the root user's home directory using `sudo ls /root`. The command executed successfully without requesting a password, confirming that the account had excessive sudo privileges.

```
sudo ls /root
```

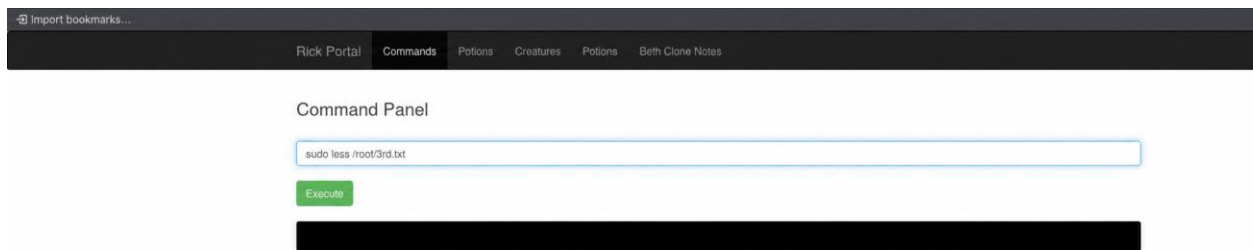
Evidence - Elevated listing of /root.



The directory contained 3rd.txt, so I read it with the same elevated privileges.

```
sudo less /root/3rd.txt
```

Evidence - Contents of /root/3rd.txt.



```
Final ingredient: [REDACTED]
```

Answer summary

The three room questions were answered in the same order in which the ingredients were discovered.

Question	Evidence location	Answer
First	Sup3rS3cretPick13Ingred.txt (web directory)	[REDACTED]
Second	/home/rick/second ingredients	[REDACTED]
Final	/root/3rd.txt	[REDACTED]